Chapter 8 Food Microbiology

Learning Objectives

- Understand the role of microorganisms in food.
- Know the conditions that lead to food spoilage.
- Understand the signs of spoilage foods.
- Learn the method of prevention of food poisoning.
- Be aware of importance of kitchen hygiene and safety.

Food that is consumed should be safe and wholesome. Food should be protected from contamination at all stages till it is consumed. A number of microorganisms are associated with different kinds of food and they are divided into three groups.

i Microorganisms that bring about useful changes in the preparation of certain foods.
ii Microorganisms that bring about spoilage of food and
iii Those that cause food poisoning and infections.

DO YOU KNOW?

Bacteria are in our body?
The human mouth is a home to more than 500 species of bacteria. Each square centimeter of your skin averages about 100,000 bacteria (https://microbeonline.com/amazing-world-of-microbes-some-unbelievable-facts-about-microorganisms/.).

8.1 Role of Microorganisms in Food

A number of microorganisms are involved in bringing about changes and are useful in the preparation of certain foods. Microorganisms that are useful to mankind are utilized on a small scale in home and on a large scale in food industry. The important role of microorganisms in food are:-

1. ***Production of alcoholic beverages*:** Yeast is used in great deal in the preparation of alcoholic beverages such as wine, beer, brandy, fermentation of milk.



▲ Plate 8.1 Alcoholic Beverages

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